

# **Core Management Skills for Teachers**

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# **Core Management Skills for Teachers**

## **1. INTRODUCTION**

A teacher does many jobs in school. She teaches, checks work and controls the class. Every teacher is the manager of her class. The skills for this job are called management skills.

## **2. MEANING OF MANAGEMENT SKILLS**

Management means doing work in a good and planned way. Management skill means knowing how to plan and run work. For a teacher, it means running the class well.

Fayol (1949) gave five functions of management. Function means a main job. The five functions are given below.

- Planning means deciding work before doing it
- Organizing means putting things in place
- Commanding means telling people what to do
- Coordinating means making all parts work together
- Controlling means checking if work is right

## **3. IMPORTANCE OF MANAGEMENT SKILLS**

Management skills are very important for a teacher. They help in five ways.

- Class stays calm and in order
- Time is used in a good way
- Students learn better
- Teacher works with less worry
- School gets good results

## **4. KATZ'S THREE SKILLS**

Katz (1955) said a manager needs three skills. Manager means a person who runs work.

- Technical skill means knowing the work well
- Human skill means working well with people
- Conceptual skill means seeing the whole school

A teacher needs all three skills. She must know her work, her students and her school.

## **5. CORE MANAGEMENT SKILLS FOR TEACHERS**

A teacher needs six core management skills. Core means main and most important.

### **5.1 Planning Skill**

Planning skill means deciding work before class. The teacher makes a lesson plan for each day. For example, she plans a Science lesson on plants.

### **5.2 Organizing Skill**

Organizing skill means putting things in place. The teacher keeps books, charts and chalk ready. For example, she puts students in groups for Math work.

### **5.3 Classroom Control Skill**

Classroom control skill means keeping good order in class. The teacher makes clear class rules. For example, she asks students to raise hands before speaking.

### **5.4 Time Management Skill**

Time management skill means using time in a good way. The teacher starts and ends the class on time. For example, she gives ten minutes for Urdu reading.

### **5.5 Communication Skill**

Communication skill means talking and listening in a clear way. The teacher speaks slowly and listens to students. For example, she uses easy words in English class.

### **5.6 Motivation Skill**

Motivation skill means making students want to learn. The teacher says good words for good work. For example, she gives a star in the Math copy.

**Table 1: Six Core Management Skills**

| <b>Skill</b>             | <b>Meaning</b>                       | <b>Example</b>               |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------|------------------------------|
| <b>Planning</b>          | Deciding work before class           | Lesson plan for Science      |
| <b>Organizing</b>        | Putting things in place              | Students in groups for Math  |
| <b>Classroom Control</b> | Keeping good order in class          | Raise hands before speaking  |
| <b>Time Management</b>   | Using time in a good way             | Ten minutes for Urdu reading |
| <b>Communication</b>     | Talking and listening in a clear way | Easy words in English class  |
| <b>Motivation</b>        | Making students want to learn        | Star in the Math copy        |

## **6. PROBLEMS TEACHERS FACE**

Teachers in Pakistan face many problems. Four main problems are given below.

- Large classes with many students
- Not enough books and charts
- Extra work outside the class
- Little training for teachers

## **7. HOW TO IMPROVE MANAGEMENT SKILLS**

A teacher can improve these skills in four ways. The four ways are given below.

- Join training classes for teachers
- Learn from good senior teachers
- Plan every lesson before class
- Read books about teaching

## **8. CONCLUSION**

Every teacher is the manager of her class. She needs planning, organizing and classroom control skills. She also needs time management, communication and motivation skills. With these six skills, her students learn better.

## REFERENCES

Fayol, H. (1949). General and industrial management. Pitman.

Katz, R. L. (1955). Skills of an effective administrator. Harvard Business Review, 33(1), 33-42.